

In-Domain Design Interview Guide



Welcome to your preparation guide for your interview at Meta! This guide will take you approximately 15 minutes to review. Use the table of contents below to quickly jump to the section you are looking for. Whether you’re taking your initial screen or your full loop interview, our Camera Engineering leaders and recruiters put together this guide so you know what to expect and how to prepare. We recognize that interviewing can be stressful, so we hope this guide provides the information and resources you need. Remember, your recruiter is there to support you, so please reach out to them with any questions.

What you’ll find in this guide	
Accommodations process.....	2
Team introduction.....	2
Interview process overview.....	2
In-Domain Design: Camera Systems.....	3
Final tips for your interview.....	4
Post interview – What to expect.....	5
Appendix / Resources.....	5

Accommodations process

Meta is committed to providing reasonable support (called accommodations) in our recruiting processes for qualified candidates with disabilities, physical conditions, mental health conditions, neurodivergence, sincerely held religious beliefs, pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions, as required by law. If you need assistance or require an accommodation, reach out via the [Accommodations request form](#).

Team introduction

Our Camera Software teams explore, develop, and deliver new cutting-edge camera software solutions that serve as the foundation of current and future products. We have multiple openings in which some of the work entails being responsible for rapidly building and iterating on the most-innovative and life-changing camera products, working at the intersection of AI and camera, and building the foundation of future ARVR products.

These are 0->1 opportunities, and you will be building something completely new. Our goal is to leverage Computational Photography and Computer Vision to develop camera algorithms and systems to power new camera driven features, formats and experiences that power a variety of use cases across Facebook apps and products.

Interview process overview

This guide will explain what to expect during your interviews with Meta. As part of your interview, you will have the opportunity to meet with peers, cross-functional partners, and other leaders at Meta. Your recruiter will be your guide throughout the process and aim to adequately prepare you to bring your best self to your interview.

What is Covered in this Guide?

This guide will specifically cover the “In-Domain Design” portion of your interview. Please refer to the Full Loop Guide for details regarding the other rounds (Coding, Behavioral, etc.)

Video Conference interview best practices

- Make sure you're in a quiet environment.
- Double check that you have a reliable internet/phone connection.
- It's okay to ask the person you're speaking with to speak slowly if you can't catch what they're saying.
- You'll need a laptop with a webcam, speaker, and mic. We recommend using a headset or headphones with a mic for better quality audio, but this is optional.
- While we embrace the usage of advanced tooling in our day-to-day work to build the future of social connection, we ask that you not use any unauthorized outside assistance during interviews. Throughout the interview process you may be asked to share your screen via Zoom. Here you can find [guidance](#) on how this works. Additionally, we ask that you disable and not use filters during your interview. This will help us get an understanding of how you approach problem-solving and coding independently. Outside assistance includes, but is not limited to, consulting external resources, seeing help from others, or using AI tools, like ChatGPT.
 - For your interview, ensure Zoom screen sharing is enabled in advance, as setup may require a few minutes. Here's how: [Enable Zoom screen share](#).
 - A filter is considered any tool/feature that applies visual effects to your video feed, including virtual/blurred background.

Interview Dress Code

As you're probably aware, we promote a casual environment at Meta so that everyone can be their authentic selves. Formal dress is not required (jeans are definitely ok!). Dress comfortably. We care about what you can do, not what you wear.

In-Domain Design: Camera Systems

What can you expect?

We're looking to understand your thought process and approach, given a domain you're familiar with. The purpose of this interview is to understand your knowledge/experience with camera systems development and to assess your understanding of various camera topics.

A small portion of the interview will be knowledge based, where we'll look to understand how you've contributed to previous projects, but most of the time we'll be assessing your camera system design skills. You are expected to ask clarifying questions, understand the problem, and drive the conversation forward by discussing the pros and cons of the different approaches that are discussed.

It may be helpful to imagine you are partnering with the business or a client, and this is your kick-off design meeting to strategize and conceptualize the end to end system.

What do we look for?

Your interviewer will be thinking about how your skills and experience might be impactful at Meta as well as how you tackle problems you're not as familiar with. In your In-Domain Design Interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on four focus areas:

- **Problem Navigation:** Ask clarifying questions to systematically reduce ambiguity, break the problem down to smaller sections, target the most important problems to solve, understand constraints, and define a requirement set.
- **Solution Design:** Design an effective working solution that addresses the critical aspects of the problem. Consider the big picture or broader context in your design. Approach layering and organization of components thoughtfully. Keep scale, user experience, and multiple developer scenarios in mind.
- **Technical Communication:** Articulate your technical ideas, viewpoints, and vision. Communicate your reasoning in a logical, clear, and concise manner. Discuss tradeoffs of the different options; consider pros/cons and long term consequences. Listen closely to feedback from your interviewer and incorporate that into your design as appropriate.
- **Technical Excellence:** Dive deeply into technical details. Articulate dependencies and tradeoffs in the solution. Identify and focus on solving the critical/challenging aspects of the problem, including foreseeing and mitigating potential failure points and non-functional aspects (e.g., maintainability, testability, etc). The goal is to produce a complete end-to-end solution and deep dive on 1-2 areas to showcase domain expertise.

How to prep

We are not looking for you to be an expert in every area, but candidates should know enough of the critical areas to weigh design considerations and know when to consult an expert. We also don't expect you to design the perfect system or have the answer ready right away. There are certain levels of ambiguity built into the interview questions intentionally.

If you come across a topic that you're not familiar with, or the question seems vague, don't panic! Part of the interview assessment is on whether you can solve problems in unfamiliar space with your existing domain knowledge.

You will be asked to solve one problem and design a component of a high-performance real-time engine based on the requirements. You will be interviewing with a Meta software engineer or engineering leader who has domain expertise in this area.

Topics that are helpful to be familiar with include (but are not limited to):

- e2e camera system
- ISP
- Android camera stack
- One of the 3As: Auto White Balance, Auto Exposure and/or Auto Focus
- Video encoding/decoding
- Linux kernel driver
- Operating system concepts including processes, threads, mutexes, interrupt handling, and
- exception handling
- Power and memory management, thermals

Final tips for your interview

- **Be yourself.** This means being open and honest about your successes and ways you've improved throughout your career. Also, be sure to call out how you have specifically added value to your team or projects you've contributed to. We value teamwork and what each individual member brings to the table.
- **Carefully review and familiarize yourself with the job description and perform research on Meta and the role.** Be prepared to answer why you are interested in this specific role and in working at Meta.
- **Please take the time to review our [mission statement](#) and [core values](#).** These values influence how we work together to fulfill our mission to build the future of human connection and the technology that makes it possible. We also encourage you to take time using our technologies such as Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, and WhatsApp.
- **One important piece of advice for your interviews: it's ok if you don't know!** No one who works at Meta is

an expert in all things, and we don't look for perfection in the people we interview. If you aren't sure of something during your interview, you're encouraged to ask clarifying questions and be upfront if there are topics that you have less experience with.

- **Prepare thoughtful questions for the interviewer(s).** Your interviewer may challenge your ideas, and you should be ready to speak not only to what you recommend or have experienced but the why as well. It is important to think outside the box and to approach problems from creative and different perspectives.

Post interview – What to expect

You can expect your recruiter to provide a specific timeline or updates along the way. Your recruiter will inform you of next steps after your interview as soon as they are available. Feel free to follow up with them if you have not heard within a week of your interviews.

Appendix / Resources

Below is a curated list of resources to get started and help you prepare.

Meta resources

- [About Meta](#) website
- [Meta Newsroom](#) website
- [Meta Careers](#) website
- [Culture at Meta](#) website
- [Meta employee benefits](#) website
- [Interviewing at Meta: The keys to success](#) blog

Update personal information, track interview progress, and send thank you notes.

At any time during the interview process, you can track your progress, send thank-you notes and update your personal information all via the [Career Profile](#). If you do not receive a link from recruiting, you may create one.

Thank you for taking the time to review this guide!